



Running

From fast sprints to long-distance endurance races, there are lots of running events in track and field. Running short distances requires explosive **speed**; athletes who run long distances need energy and **stamina**.

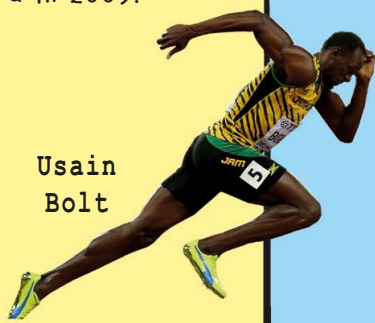
Sprints and distances

The distances for running at the **Olympics** are divided into sprints, middle-distance races, and long-distance races. They are:

100m

The shortest running event takes place on the straight section of a running track. Jamaica's Usain Bolt broke the world record in 2009.

Usain Bolt



200m

Athletes start the 200m race on the curve of a track and finish on a straight. American Florence Griffith-Joyner set the women's record in 1988 and it's never been beaten.

Florence Griffith-Joyner



400m

This race takes place around a full lap of the track. Runners either start quickly and try to keep a good pace, or increase their speed near the end.



800m

The shortest of the middle-distance races, the 800m requires both stamina and speed. Athletes run two laps of the track.

David Rudisha